

Six-round tubular magazine

Cocking slide

Bayonet lug

▼ NAILED COSH

Date 1916

Origin UK

The simplest trench-fighting weapons were clubs and truncheons, often – as in this example – with nails or spikes added to increase their lethality, and usually with a retaining loop.



Horse-shoe nail

▲ BRITISH SPIKED CLUB

Date c.1916

Origin UK

This club, hand-whittled from hardwood, incorporates both horseshoe nails and a stabbing spike in its enlarged head. It also has serrations to improve the grip, and a wrist-strap for security.



Bayonet mount

Conical pommel nut

Manufacturer's initials and date



Brass knuckle-duster grip

▲ WINCHESTER TRENCH GUN

Date 1897

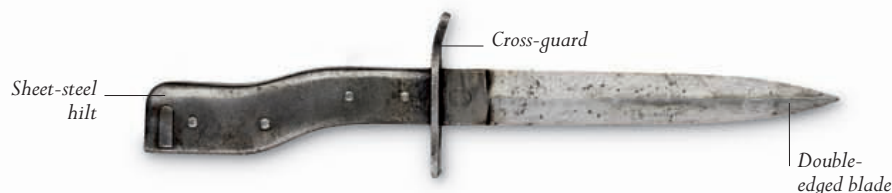
Origin US

Weight 3.6kg (8lb)

Barrel 51cm (20in)

Calibre 12-bore

The Winchester Repeating Arms Company commissioned gun-designer John Moses Browning to develop a pump-action shotgun, and he produced the M1897. Its six-round magazine made it extremely useful to the combat infantryman.



Cross-guard

Double-edged blade

▲ GERMAN "ERSATZ" KNIFE BAYONET

Date 1917

Origin Germany

Weight 220g (7¾oz)

Length 26.1cm (10¼in)

This short, double-edged bayonet, developed privately to fit the Mauser GeW'98 rifle, doubled as a combat knife, and many German soldiers bought one for themselves.



▲ FRENCH TRENCH KNIFE

Date 1916

Origin France

This was a simple stabbing and slashing weapon with a double-edged blade, a steel cross-guard, and an unadorned wooden grip, perhaps made at Laguiole in the Aveyron département of south-central France.

► NO. 36 MILLS BOMB

Date 1915

Origin UK

Weight 765g (27oz)

Length 95.2mm (3¾in)

Grenades became more effective when reliable time-fuses became available. The British Mills Bomb, with its "pineapple" casing filled with a TNT-based explosive called Baratol, was the first of its type, and was widely copied.



Safety pin

Spring-loaded firing lever held down by safety pin

Cuts to promote fragmentation

◀ AMERICAN KNUCKLE-DUSTER TRENCH KNIFE

Date 1918–45

Origin US

Weight 500g (17½oz)

Length 56cm (22in)

This combination weapon's conical pommel nut was designed to puncture the human skull. The spiked knuckle-duster made a punch potentially lethal, while the blade was used to slash or stab.